

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5
 ♥ A 9
 ♦ A 10 7 3
 ♣ K Q 9 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q 10 8 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5



♠ Q J 4 2

♥ 6

♦ K Q J 5

♣ J 10 6 2

♠ A K 7 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ A 8 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live happily ever after.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 4
 ♥ Q 8 6
 ♦ A 9 6 3
 ♣ J 6 4 2

♠ 6
 ♥ A K J 10 5 4
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ A K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 9 8 7 5 2
 ♥ 9
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ 8 7

♠ A 3
 ♥ 7 3 2
 ♦ Q J 10 8 4
 ♣ 10 9 3

West	North	East	South
		4♠	

All Pass

4♠ by East
 partner for the ♥Q they can make slam.

This is what preempting is all about.

You dealt this hand.

With 7 estimated winners and an 8-card suit you preempt 4♠. And you are not going to make it. In fact you are only going to make 8 tricks so you will go down 2.

You may be wishing that you had opened just 3♠, rather than following the guidelines and opening at the 4-level. The problem with that thinking is that the lower your preempt, the less difficult it is for the opponent's to enter the bidding. If you had opened 3♠ South might have been able to make a Takeout Double and they could have found their ♥ fit. Just visualize their combined hands; they have 9 ♥s between them, they have no ♠ losers, no ♣ losers and just one ♦ loser. If they decide to finesse your